

## Lesson 1 • Writing

# Understanding line graphs.



What line graphs are, how to read them, and what IELTS Writing Task 1 asks you to do with them.



## LEARNING OBJECTIVES



# By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

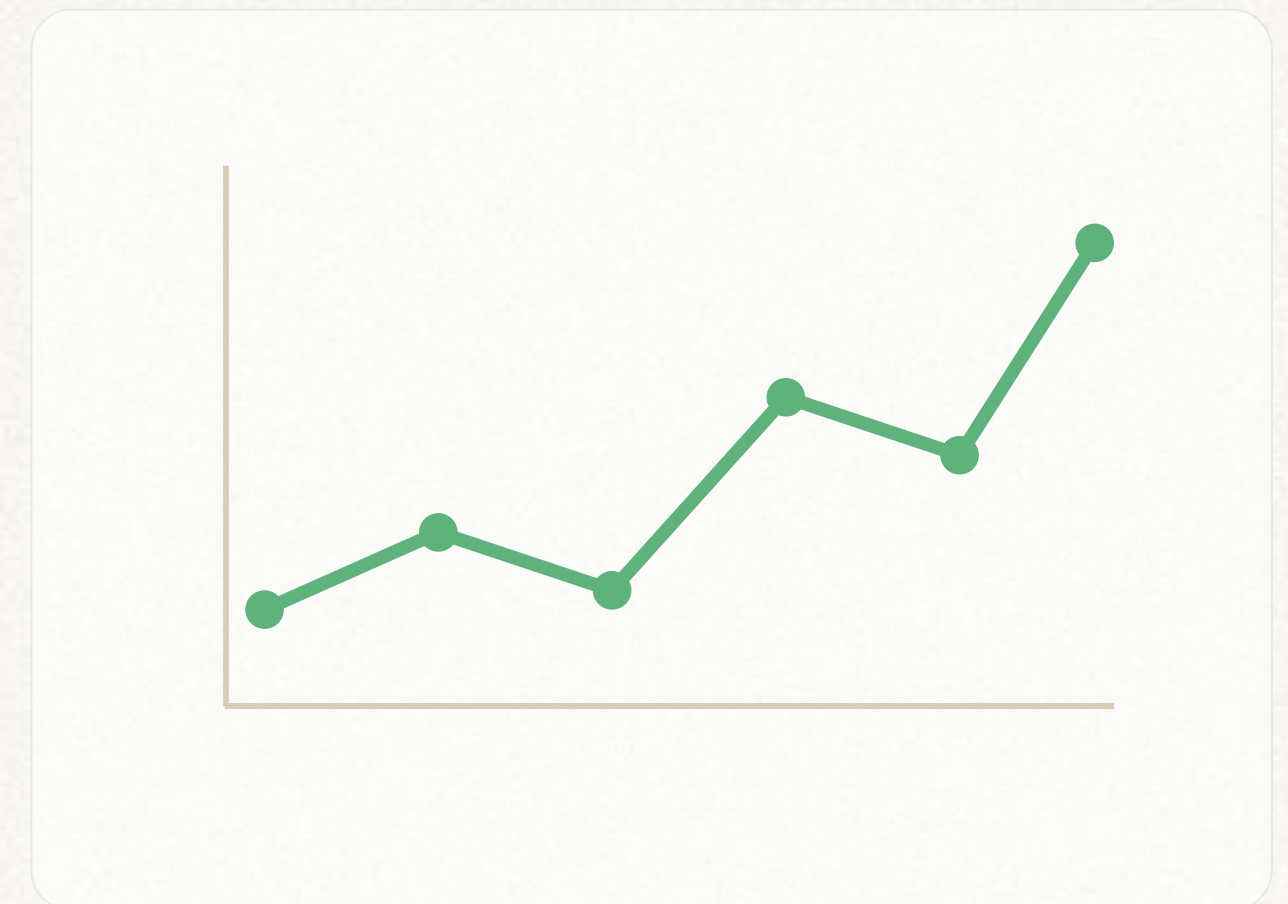
- |          |                                               |          |                                              |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------|----------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>0</b> | Identify the key parts of a line graph.       | <b>0</b> | Recognise the difference between single and  |
| <b>1</b> |                                               | <b>2</b> | and multiple line graphs.                    |
| <b>0</b> | Explain what IELTS Writing Task 1 asks you to | <b>0</b> | Identify the key features to include in your |
| <b>3</b> | do.                                           | <b>4</b> | your answer.                                 |



### WHAT IS A LINE GRAPH?

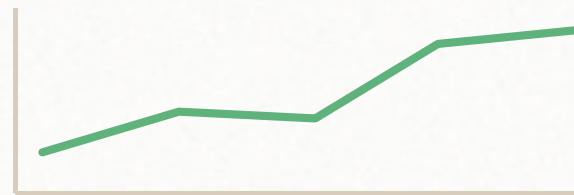
A line graph shows how **something changes over time**

It's the **most common chart type** in IELTS Writing Task 1.





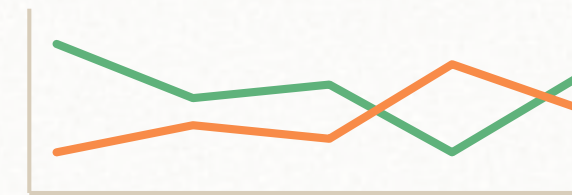
# Single or multiple, read them differently.



## Single line

Tracks one category over time, no comparison needed. Focus on the **shape and stages** of the trend.

"rose steadily, then plateaued, before climbing sharply"



## Multiple lines

Several trends to compare. Focus on **similarities, differences**, and the **crossover points** between lines.

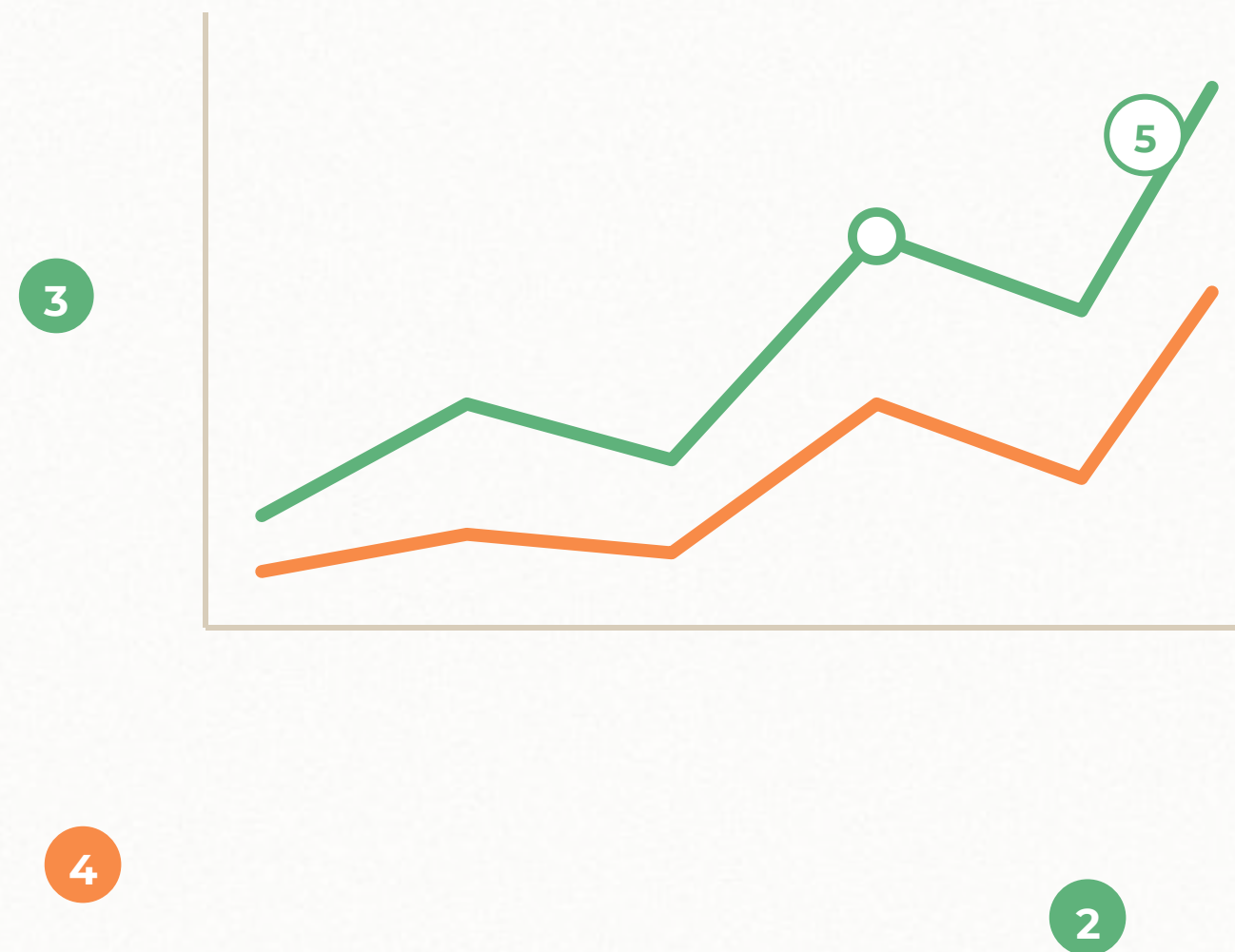
"tea sales overtook coffee sales in 2015"



## PARTS OF A LINE GRAPH

**Know every part before you write.**

1 Internet users by age, 2010–2020



### examiner mode

- 1 **Title**, what's being measured.
- 2 **X-axis**, the time period.
- 3 **Y-axis**, the quantity measured, plus units (% , kg , millions).
- 4 **Legend**, which line is which.
- 5 **Data point**, the exact value at a given time.

**reminder** Always include **units** when describing values.



## WHAT TASK 1 ASKS YOU TO DO

**The instruction always asks three things:** follow the 3 steps  
steps →

**01**  
**Select**

Choose the most important  
facts. Don't describe everything.

**02**  
**Describe**

Report the data accurately  
with the right units.

**03**  
**Compare**

Show how the lines relate  
to each other.

### common mistake, repeating numbers

#### WEAK

The number went up a lot.

Lots of people used it.

#### STRONGER

The number **increased sharply**.

A **large proportion** used it.



## KEY FEATURES TO NOTICE

# Before you write, look for these five things.

### 01 Overall trend

Is it going up, down, or staying stable?

### 03 Significant changes

Sharp rises or sudden falls.

### 05 Comparisons

Which line is highest, or whether lines cross.

### 02 Start and end points

Where each line begins and finishes.

### 04 Peaks and troughs

The highest and lowest points.



# Match **each term to its definition.**

Drag each term on the left to the meaning it belongs with on the right.

**Title**

What's being measured, the heading of the graph.

**X-axis**

The time period running along the bottom.

**Y-axis**

The quantity measured, running up the side.

**Legend**

The key showing which line is which.

**Data points**

The exact values plotted on each line.

**Units**

How values are counted, %, kg, millions.



## KEY TAKEAWAYS

# What to carry into your writing.

- A line graph shows **change over time**, check the title, axes, and units first.
- Graphs can be **single or multiple**, read each kind differently.
- Task 1 asks you to **select, describe, and compare**, not describe everything.
- Look for the **overall trend, start/end points, peaks, troughs**, and comparisons.

next up →

**Vocabulary for Trends**